

PURPOSE: To specify the regulations for tardies (a Level One Offense), and change the tardy count from each semester to each nine weeks.

INTRODUCED BY: Komal Patel

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

In the handbook, the consequences for tardies are listed with other Level One (Exception) offenses such as technology violation, violation of dress code, and public displays of affection. While consequences are necessary for addressing these infractions, the accumulation of tardies is not adequately described. In the first mention of tardies, the handbook does state that “Level I Exception violations, except for tardies, will be carried over and accumulated for the entire year.” Currently, MSMS operates under the notion that tardies reset each semester; however, the handbook does not state when the accumulation will restart for this offense. This could be very confusing for students and parents (who receive notifications each tardy).

After a first offense for a tardy, the punishments change to extra work service (2 hours), Saturday school (4 hours), weekend resident hall restriction, or referral as a level II or III, consecutively. With MSMS students already having so many obligations, a punishment such as 2 or 4 extra hours of service can be detrimental to a student’s time. Also, considering the unpredictable nature of tardiness, it's understandable that unforeseen circumstances could occasionally lead students to be late.

With these two things in mind, this bill aims to clarify the terms of a tardy and ease restrictions. By restarting the tardy count to every nine weeks, students will have a chance for leniency, and not suffer such dire consequences from two misconducts in only one semester. By clarifying the time intervals for tardies, students will have less of a chance of losing time to study or participate in school events on the weekends.

SECTION TWO (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On page 124 of the Student Handbook (PDF page 129) under the section “Discipline & School Safety” the following would be changed to:

LEVEL ONE (EXCEPTIONS) – Level I Exception violations, except for tardies, will be carried over and accumulated for the entire year. No Level I violations will be carried over to the following school year.

OFFENSE	CONSEQUENCE
---------	-------------

1. TARDINESS TO ACADEMIC CLASSES

Beginning with the ~~sixth day of the fall semester and sixth day of each nine~~ weeks the consequences for tardiness in academic class will start.

FIRST OFFENSE:

- Warning from Director for Academic Affairs
- Parent notified

SECOND OFFENSE:

- 2 hours extra work service (satisfactory work completion determined by supervisor)
- Parent notified

THIRD OFFENSE:

- Saturday school (2 hours)
- Parent notified

FOURTH OFFENSE:

- Saturday School (4 hours)
- Referral to administration as Level II
- Parent conference required

FIFTH OFFENSE:

- In Hall Restriction (3 days)
- Referral to administration as Level II
- Probation
- Parent conference required

SIXTH OFFENSE:

- Referral to administration as Level III
- parent conference required